ALEXANDER OWENS

Senior Applied Scientist

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[LinkedIn]

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Applied Scientist

Zillow Group

March 2024 - current Seattle, WA

- Architected a listing-understanding pipeline with Databricks Mosaic AI that ***improved lead-to-tour conversion by 7.4%*** across high-intent home-search journeys.
- Spearheaded retrieval improvements with FAISS, cutting semantic search response time by 182 milliseconds for property and neighborhood queries.
- Directed experimentation roadmaps that unlocked $1.86M in projected annual value by improving ranking quality for buyer-facing recommendations.
- Orchestrated model deployment workflows on Kubernetes, shrinking release stabilization time to 27 hours for production recommendation services.

Senior Data Scientist

T-Mobile US

September 2021 - February 2024 Bellevue, WA

- Optimized hyperparameter search with Ray Tune, lifting churn model precision by 6.1 points for retention-focused customer segments.
- Modeled roaming and usage behavior across 14 subscriber cohorts using Python and Pandas, refining marketing strategies that led to a ***17% increase in successful upsells***.
- Revamped experimentation readouts, reducing insight delivery time by 9 days for marketing and customer-lifecycle stakeholders.

Data Scientist II

Expedia Group

June 2019 - August 2021 Bellevue, WA

- Developed demand forecasts with GluonTS to enhance booking accuracy over a 9-month horizon for destination-level planning.
- Refined ranking features on 2.7M traveler sessions, resulting in a 13% increase in booking conversion rates for targeted traveler segments.
- Accelerated deep learning workflows with PyTorch Lightning, ***trimming experiment runtime by 31 GPU-hours*** per training cycle.

EDUCATION

B.S.

Data Science

University of Washington

2014 - 2018

Seattle, WA

SKILLS

- PyTorch Lightning
- Ray Tune
- Databricks Mosaic AI
- FAISS
- Kubernetes
- GluonTS
- Long-horizon ownership
- Ambiguity-to-model framing